2.4

Meerut: Adieu to Lucky Seven

Soon after moving to Meerut in mid-1994, Col AVS Ghuman took over the Bn on his promotion. As the senior-most Major, apart from my main role as the HQ Company Commander, I also officiated as the 2iC. During our tenure at Kaksar, the Companies had been on their own at isolated posts, infrequently visited by senior officers and with little centralized command. Because of the nature of the deployment in close proximity to Pakistani posts, standards of turnout, discipline and training had dropped. Nothing alarming, since it happens during all field tenures, and hence the peace tenure to get the standards up again before deploying to the next field. At Meerut, we were part of 32 Inf Bde of 9 Inf Div, which also had its HQ at Meerut. The Div had both a primary defensive role and a secondary offensive role with its area of operations in Punjab. The GOCs of the Division were Maj Gen SG Pitre (Engineers) and later Maj Gen JJ Singh (MARATHA LI), who would go on to become the twenty-first Chief of the Army Staff (COAS). The Brigade Commanders were Brig Yadav (Armoured) and Brig Chauhan (Guards–Mech).

Copyright @ Penguin Random House India
Not for circulation

Four Stars of Destiny.indd 104 11/28/2023 12:45:12 PM